# Statement

Sensitive

**Statement in the matter of R v Vida REID**

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| **Name** | Merina CRAIG |
| **Occupation** | Carer |
| **Address** | Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) |
| **Date** | 14 October 2022 |

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

2. My full name is Merina CRAIG I am 86 years of age.

3. My residential address is known to the National Disability Insurance Scheme.

4. I am the mother and nominee for my daughter Janine Craig.

5. Janine has a diagnosis of Intellectual disability. Janine's disability impacts on all parts of her life. Her disability was caused at her birth due to lack of oxygen. Janine has problems with her mobility, communication, social interaction, learning, self-care and self-management affecting social and/or economic participation.

6. Janine gained access to the NDIS on 4th of February 2019. Janine's NDIS number is 431081450.

7. Janine's first plan was dated 16th of May 2019 and was for $107851.38. Janine's current plan is dated 7th October 2022 and the plan is due for review on the 7th of October 2023 for the amount $149167.39.

M V Craig

..... Signature

..... Witness

8. Janine requires someone to come and help with her communication skills, which her OT is working on with her.

9. Lyn comes in and helps me with my shopping and takes Janine with her. Janine loves to go shopping. Lyn takes Janine to the pool which she loves. Lyn is a very important part of Janine's life.

10. The supports that Janine receives are 10 hours per week with her support worker Lyn MAHER. When Lyn arrives she clicks on a gadget that shows that she has arrived and clicks again when she leaves, this sends a message to her office and this can not be changed.

11. Lyn comes in on a Monday, Tuesday and Friday. I have never had any supports come in on a weekend.

12. Lyn works for Peel Homecare Community Supports.

13. I have a gardener that comes to the home once a month for about three hours.

14. Alex from forward focussed group (FFG) is Janine's support coordinator. At least he was but I have not spoken to him for at least three weeks.

15. Janine sees her Occupational Therapist every fortnight for one and a half hours.

16. Janine was originally connected with another provider but I had issues with them and invoices that they were submitting, I also did not like the support workers that they were providing. They actually stopped providing services as there were legal problems.

17. Alex was with FFG and has been Janine's support coordinator from the start.

18. I received a call from a woman who called herself Vida, she said that she could help me manage Janine's plan. I am not sure how she got my phone number.

M L Craig

.....
Signature

.....
Witness

19. This was about two years ago, Vida, a female wearing a head scarf, Alex and another male came to my house. They said they were from Focus and they were going to be my new company. That dealt with NDIS.

20. Alex said that they were going to manage Janine's plan, and I was not to worry, all the invoices would go to FFG and they would handle everything.

21. I agreed to let them manage Janine's plan and I signed a document but I cannot be sure if it was on paper or computer.

22. Vida drove a Black BMW and she had long black hair, she had a handbag studded with jewels and I was not impressed. I did not like her from the start. Vida saw my mobile phone and she commented on it. It is an old $80 phone from the post office.

23. Vida came to my house and gave me what she called a present. It was a new iPhone. I told her I didn't need it. She did not take it back, but I gave it to Alex to return it to her.

24. About a month ago Alex bought a iPad to the house. He said that it was for Janine. He had arranged everything in relation to this.

25. Investigator LANE has asked me about Hybrid Hive Pty - I have never heard of them.

26. Investigator LANE then asked me to comment on Hybrid Hive claiming $70,572.17 for Self-care for Janine. – Get all the bloody back. It was never done.

27. Investigator LANE has asked me to comment on FFG claiming Support Coordination - I worked with Alex from FFG. I did not hear from him that much from him, I rang him when I needed something, I spoke to him once every few months.

28. Investigator LANE has asked me to comment on FFG claiming Capacity Building and Training in Self-Management and Plan Management, - Tell them to return the bloody money.

29. Investigator LANE has asked me to comment on FFG claiming Assistance With Decision Making Daily Planning and Budgeting, Skills - Tell them to return the bloody money.

30. Investigator LANE has asked me to comment on FFG claiming Development And Training - Tell them to return the bloody money.

31. Investigator LANE has asked me to comment on FFG claiming Assessment Recommendation Therapy or Training – Counsellor - Tell them to return the bloody money.

32. I am not sure how many hours of support coordination Alex claimed that was legitimate- so can not be sure how much was false.

33. I can say that the other supports that were claimed for $15853.70 were all false. They never supplied these supports to Janine.

34. I never gave FFG or Hybrid Hive permission to claim supports from Janine's plan. Especially Hybrid Hive.

35. Other than OT, Lyn coming to work with Janine and the gardener no other supports have been supplied.

36. I have not signed any service agreements with FFG or Hybrid Hive. I have only signed with Peel home and community supports.

37. I had a phone call from NDIS who asked me about the consent that is on Janine's NDIS file. I was asked about Linda Lee (chorus), Vida Reid, Leah Norman, Chloe Osborne, Terri Roberts, Simon Reid and Mayra Rivas from Forward Focused Group. I told him to remove them as I have never heard of them.

38. This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

Signature _____
Merina CRAIG

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about 2.10 p.m. on 14 October 2022 at Perth in Western Australia.

Signature _____
Fiona LANE Senior Investigator
Perth